REQUIREMENTS ELICITATION TOOLKIT

“Think – See – Feel – Do” Persona Empathy Map

Purpose: This empathy map helps you step into a persona's perspective by separating what they think, what they see, what they feel, and what they actually do. Gaps between these quadrants — e.g. what someone says vs. what they do — often point to unspoken needs that matter for requirements elicitation.

Group: 6, ThinkFeelImagine

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Persona interviewed: Persona 1

Date: 27/8/2026

1. Persona Snapshot

Set the scene: who is this persona, and what situation or moment are you analyzing?

Persona name	Amara Diallo
Role / occupation	Operations Director
Context / organization	The organization builds and operates small solar-battery microgrids that supply electricity to villages with no connection to the national grid, charging households through prepaid mobile-money top-ups. Billing, meter readings, and maintenance requests are currently tracked through a mix of a basic mobile app and paper logs kept by local site technicians.
SDG or focus area	SDG 7 — Affordable and Clean Energy
Situation being analyzed	Amara Diallo, Operations Director at a renewable energy company, oversees solar microgrids for off-grid villages, facing challenges in fair billing and payment flexibility while needing a transparent system for donor funding.

2. Think – See – Feel – Do

Fill in each quadrant from the persona's point of view. Base this on what they told you in the interview, plus reasonable inferences from their context — note which is which as you go.

THINK

• What occupies their thoughts?

have a real chance to build something that works for how our people operate in the field.

• What matters most to them right now?

Getting a system that works and proves that money is being collected.

• What are they worried or uncertain about?

Whether the technicians will use whatever we build, because if they revert to paper logs, then they're back to square one.

SEE

• What does their environment look like?

Chaotic, messy desk, small office, noisy.

• What do they encounter day to day?

phone calls from technicians who are standing in the middle of a village trying to explain a situation I can't visualize.

• Who and what surrounds them?

surrounded by incomplete information, context and spreadsheets with gaps.

FEEL

• What emotions come up for them?

low-level anxiety, frustration

• What gives them confidence? What causes stress?

When a technician calls and she can tell they understand what's happening in their village, that reassures her. And when Fatou tells me a donor is satisfied, she feels like she's doing something real.

• What are they afraid of or hopeful about?

Afraid - scaling too fast and losing the trust of the communities

Hopeful - If she gets it right, we have a model that actually works and can keep growing.

DO

• What actions do they take?

Keeping the lights on across all village sites. Coordinating with her field technicians, managing relationships with her donor partners, and making sure the money side of things is actually working so she can keep expanding.

• What behaviors or habits stand out?

Obsessive about documentation.

Calling technicians directly when she can't make sense of a report.

• What do they say publicly vs. privately?

Publicly - talk a lot about impact, about how many households she's connected to, how she's transforming lives in these communities.

Privately - worry that she doesn't actually have the data to back up some of those claims as rigorously as she should.

3. Pains & Gains

Looking across all four quadrants, what frustrates or blocks this persona (pains), and what would make their day meaningfully better (gains)?

Pains	Gains
Inconsistency with documentations	Modernize the documentation system.
Frustration because she doesn't know what each village is up to	Updates status online either by technician or automatically.
Chaotic and messy workspace	Dashboard which holds everything she needs.

4. Gaps & Tensions

Where do the quadrants disagree with each other? For example: they SAY one priority but their actions (DO) suggest another, or what they SEE doesn't match what they THINK is true. These gaps are often the richest source of hidden requirements.

- Gap identified: Incompleted documentation.
- What it might reveal about their real need: Inconsistency with datasource.
- Gap identified: scaling too fast and losing the trust of the communities.
- What it might reveal about their real need: A trustful system that she can rely on.

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5. Key Insights

In 2–3 sentences, summarize what this exercise revealed about the persona that a surface-level read wouldn't.

Amara’s obsession with documentation is not just about operational efficiency, but a deep need to bridge the gap between her public promises of impact and her private fear of not having the data to prove it. She needs a system that provides trustworthy, verifiable evidence for donors, not just a digital logbook. Furthermore, her habit of calling technicians to "visualize" field situations and her anxiety about scaling expose a critical need for a solution that gives her operational confidence and visual clarity remotely, directly addressing her core fear that the technicians will revert to paper if the new system feels like a burden rather than a tool. The core requirement is therefore not just a dashboard, but a trust engine that validates her work to both her team and her funders.

Tip: use this alongside the Day-in-the-Life template — the timeline shows what happens, this map shows how the persona experiences it.